

ART & CULTURE



INDIAN PAINTINGS

MODULE - 7

MODERN PAINTINGS

MINIATURES IN SOUTH INDIA



**Mysore Painting depicting
Goddess Saraswathi**

- 1** The trend of making miniature paintings was already prevalent in the south Indian States and it developed in the early Medieval period.
- 2** These were different from the North Indian Schools **owing to the heavy use of gold in these paintings.**
- 3** Furthermore, they **concentrated on painting divine creatures** much more than painting the rulers who patronized them. Some of the major schools are:

MINIATURES IN SOUTH INDIA

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TANJORE PAINTINGS



1 The Thanjavur or Tanjore School is famous for the special style of decorative paintings. The **Maratha Rulers** patronized them during the 18th century.

2 These paintings are unique as they are **mostly created on glass and board** instead of cloth and vellum preferred in north India.

3 They are unique because of the **use of brilliant colour patterns** and the **liberal use of gold leaf**.

MINIATURES IN SOUTH INDIA

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TANJORE PAINTINGS



- 4 They used many types of **gemstones** and **cut glasses** for **embellishments** to create larger than life images.
- 5 Most of the paintings depicted smiling Krishna in various poses and various major events in his life.
- 6 These paintings reached their zenith under the patronage of **Sarfoji Maharaj** who was a great patron of arts.
- 7 Currently, this school is still operational but they have moved towards experimenting with diverse subject like birds, animals, buildings etc.

MINIATURES IN SOUTH INDIA

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MYSORE PAINTINGS



- 1 These paintings were patronized by the rulers of the Mysore province and continued in the British period too.
- 2 The major theme of the Mysore paintings is the depiction of Hindu Gods and Goddesses.
- 3 The unique part of these paintings is that they had two or more figures in each painting and one figure predominates all the others in sheer size and colour.

MINIATURES IN SOUTH INDIA

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MYSORE PAINTINGS



Usage of Gesso paint

- 4 Furthermore, even the technique of making these paintings is very different from the north Indian styles.
- 5 They use the “Gesso Paste”, which is a mixture of zinc oxide and Arabic gum.
- 6 This gives a particular base to the painting that develops sheen on the background. They counter it with the use of muted colours that are not so bright so as to counteract the background.

MODERN PAINTINGS

1

COMPANY PAINTINGS

MODERN PAINTING

Company
Painting

Bazaar
Painting

Raja Ravi
Verma Painting

Bengal
School of Art

Cubist
Style

Progressive Arts
Group (PAG)



MODERN PAINTINGS

1

COMPANY PAINTINGS



1

In the colonial period, a hybrid style of painting emerged that combined the elements of Rajput, Mughal and other Indian styles of painting with European elements.

2

These paintings evolved when the British Company Officers employed painters who had been trained in Indian styles.

3

Hence, they mixed their employers' European tastes with their Indian training. This was the called the "Company Paintings".

MODERN PAINTINGS

1

COMPANY PAINTINGS



4

They were distinguished by the use of water colour and in technique by the appearance of linear perspective and shading.

5

This style of painting originated in Kolkata, Chennai, Delhi, Patna, Varanasi and Thanjavur.

6

Several painters were engaged in painting the “exotic” flora and fauna of India. The most famous of this school were Sewak Ram, Ishwari Prasad and Ghulam Ali Khan. These genre of paintings were prevalent till the 20th century.

MODERN PAINTINGS

1

COMPANY PAINTINGS

PATNA KALAM PAINTINGS

- Patna Kalam is another company style painting and it was build upon the **basic features of Mughal painting**. However their subject matter was quite different.
- Unlike the Mughal painting, which was centered over the royalty and court scenes, **flag bearers of Patna Kalam were deeply influenced by daily life of common man**. Their main subjects were local festival, ceremonies, bazaar scenes, local rulers, and domestic activities
- This set of painting **mainly catered to the European market** who deeply valued the versatility and competence of these paintings.
- The uniqueness of the school when compared to others lies in the fact that it **dealt exclusively with the commoner and his lifestyle**.

MODERN PAINTINGS

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COMPANY PAINTINGS

PATNA KALAM PAINTINGS



MODERN PAINTINGS

1

COMPANY PAINTINGS

PATNA KALAM PAINTINGS



MODERN PAINTINGS

2

BAZAAR PAINTINGS

1 This school was also influenced by the European encounter in India.

2 They were different from the company paintings as that school mixed European techniques and themes with Indian ones.

3 The Bazaar School did not take any Indian influence but took the Roman and Grecian influence. They made the painters to copy the Greek and Roman Statues.

4 This school was prevalent in the Bengal and Bihar region.

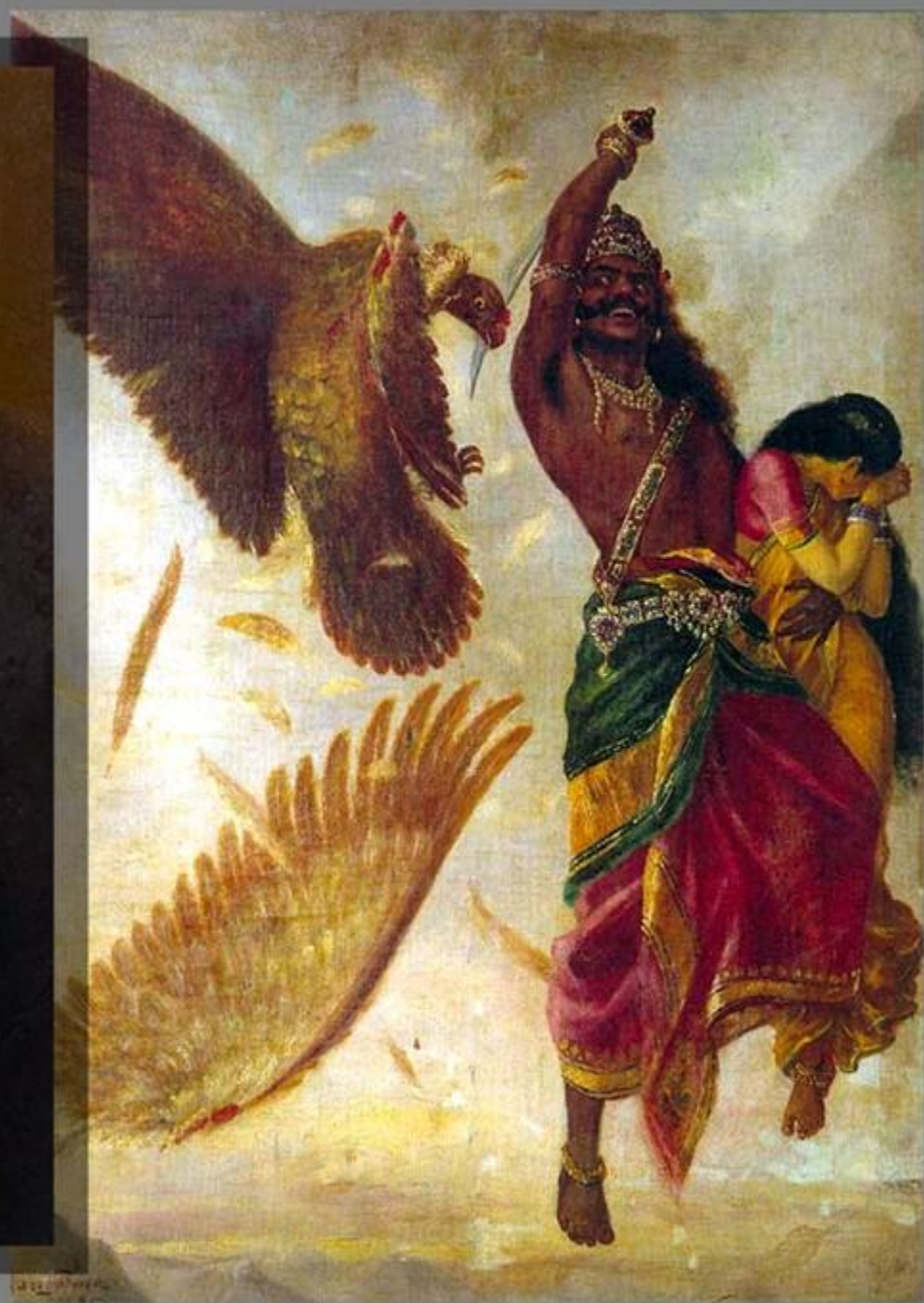
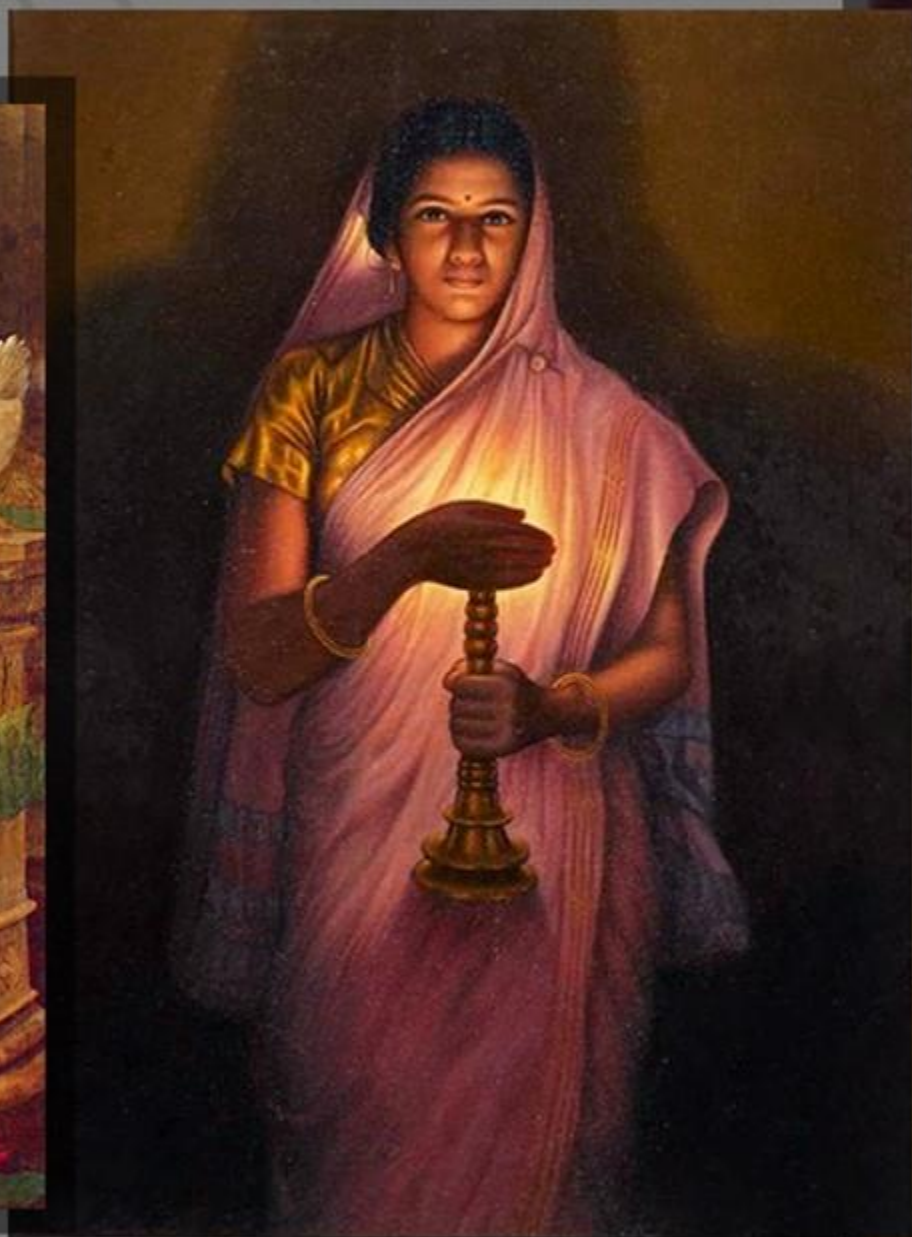
5 Apart from the Greco-roman heritage, they made paintings on everyday bazaar that showed Indian Bazaars with European background.

6 One of the most famous genres was of depicting Indian courtesans dancing before the British officials.

7 They also painted religious themes but the figures of Indian gods and Goddesses with more than two axes and elephant faces like that of Lord Ganesha were prohibited as they deviated from the European notion of natural human figurine.

RAJA RAVI VERMA- **"RAPHAEL OF THE EAST"**





MODERN PAINTINGS

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RAJA RAVI VERMA



Yashoda and son Krishna

- 1 Raja Ravi Verma is one of India's greatest painters.
- 2 He is considered to be one of the originators of the school of modern painting.
- 3 The school was called "modern" because of the heavy influence of western techniques and themes.
- 4 He was unique as he brought together elements of south Indian painting with the western techniques of colour and style.

MODERN PAINTINGS

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RAJA RAVI VERMA



Lady in the Moonlight



Mother India

5

He belonged to the State of Kerala and was dubbed the “**Raphael of the East**” because of his brilliant brush strokes and almost lifelike paintings.

6

Some of his very famous works include **Lady in the Moonlight**, **Mother India**, **Galaxy of Musicians** etc.

7

He gained nationwide recognition for his paintings from the epic Ramayana especially the one titled “**Ravana Kidnapping Sita**”.

MODERN PAINTINGS

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BENGAL SCHOOL OF ART



Arabian Night Series

- 1 The Bengal School is supposed to have a **reactionary approach to the existing styles of paintings** in the 1940-1960.
- 2 This school is unique as they **use simple colours**. The idea of the Bengal School came up with the works of **Abhanindranath Tagore**.
- 3 His **Arabian Night Series** made a mark on a global scale as it broke away from the previous schools of Indian painting and brought in something new.

MODERN PAINTINGS

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BENGAL SCHOOL OF ART

- 4 One of the most famous painters of this school is **Rabindranath Tagore**.



Usage of black lines by Tagore

- 5 His paintings are unique as **they used dominant black lines** that made the subject look very prominent.

- 6 He made small sized paintings. Some art historians argue that his paintings can be linked to his writings.

- 7 He wrote very evocative poems and the same sense of rhythm could be detected in the paintings.

- 8 Rabindranath Tagore was a **deeply spiritual person** and that is reflected in many of his paintings. Many of his students went on to become famous painters of the Bengal school.

MODERN PAINTINGS

5 CUBIST STYLE OF PAINTING



Pablo Picasso's cubist painting

- 1 The cubist movement of painting took its inspiration from the **European Cubist movement**.
- 2 Under this style, **the objects were broken, analyzed and then reassembled**.
- 3 The artist reconstructed this process on the canvas through the **use of abstract art forms**. They tried to achieve the perfect **balance between line and colour**.

MODERN PAINTINGS

5 CUBIST STYLE OF PAINTING

4 One of the most popular cubist artists in India was **M.F.Hussain**, who was named as **Picasso of India**.

5 In the paintings that used abstract connotations, he used the motif of a horse frequently as it was best to depict the free spirit and fluidity of motion.

6 His famous paintings include *Horses*, *Mother Teresa*, *Battle of Ganga Jamuna*, *Zameen* etc.



Mother Teresa



Horses

MODERN PAINTINGS

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PROGRESSIVE ARTISTS GROUP



A painting by F.N. Souza

- 1 In 1947, another group of painters grabbed the attention of art world by their use of progressive and bold themes.
- 2 They amalgamated these themes with softer and more abstract themes. The founder of this group was Francis Newton Souza but the more famous members were S.H.Raza, H.A Gada etc.
- 3 Even the famous cubist painter M.F Hussain was a member of the Progressive Artist Group.

MODERN PAINTINGS

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PROGRESSIVE ARTISTS GROUP



- 4 They organized their first art exhibition in 1948 and were patronized by **Mulk Raj Anand**.
- 5 Since then, they became a large collective and opened many galleries in Delhi and Mumbai.
- 6 They have also given opportunities to many talented young painters like Balraj Khanna, V.S.Gaitonde, Biren De who became famous.

MODERN PAINTINGS

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PROGRESSIVE ARTISTS GROUP

SOME IMPORTANT PAINTERS OF PAG

FRANCIS NEWTON SOUZA



The Mammon

- 1 A modern artist who was the founding member of Progressive Artists' Group (PAG), Bombay.
- 2 His paintings were eclectic and are known for his inventive human forms. His well-known paintings include **The Mammon**, **Last Supper**, **Christ on Palm Sunday** etc.

MODERN PAINTINGS

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PROGRESSIVE ARTISTS GROUP

SOME IMPORTANT PAINTERS OF PAG



The Bindhu

SYED HAIDER RAZA

- 1 S.H. Raza, another founding member of the PAG, was known for his abstract and expressionistic paintings which were done on acrylic and oil medium.
- 2 In later career, inspired by Indian philosophy, his paintings revolved around "Bindhu", (a dot), which symbolized a source of energy.
- 3 His paintings thus became thematic and abstract from expressionistic.

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PROGRESSIVE ARTISTS GROUP

SOME IMPORTANT PAINTERS OF PAG

SYED HAIDER RAZA



Syed Haider Raza with one of his Bindu work

4

S.H. Raza was awarded all the 3 Padma awards and he was also the first non-French artist to win the prestigious Prix de la Critique award in 1956.

5

In 2015, he was awarded with the highest French civilian honour – the Legion of Honour – also known as *Commandeur de la Légion d'Honneur*.

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